



DJI's latest acquisition

DJI acquired majority stake in Hasselblad, the Swedish camera company and is working on high-end camera drones. <http://digit.in/DJIstake>



Robotic "soft exoskeleton"

Boston-based company Rewalk Robotics is working on a "soft exoskeleton" to help rehabilitate stroke patients. <http://digit.in/RewalkBot>

6 Alternatives to cyanogenmod



With the death of the most popular and beloved line of custom ROMs for Android devices, we set out with a heavy heart to look for other custom ROMs to fill the void

Abhijit Dey
abbijit@digit.in

Power Android users who've always wanted to push their device's software capability to efficiently utilise the hardware inside are well aware of custom ROMs. The mere mention of custom ROMs naturally invokes our memory to point towards CyanogenMod. The entire CyanogenMod open source project has witnessed phenomenal popularity both from users and developers through the years. Bringing in a high-level of customisability unavailable in OEM versions of Android, users got to explore additional features on their devices. Although CyanogenMod isn't the only project out there dealing with custom ROMs for Android devices, it was the most popular among the lot. Sadly, a couple of months back, we received the news about Cyanogen Inc, the company behind CyanogenMod closing shop and shunning all their active services and projects. This meant the development of all the nightly builds of hundreds of Android devices will be terminated and none of the existing and installed software will receive any updates in the future. The company hasn't erased the years of hard work of the entire community, instead CyanogenMod's source code has been preserved under the new Lineage OS open source project. It would be too

early to comment on how the new project will turn out to be but the reality still stands that we won't be seeing much of CyanogenMod anymore.

It's devastating for some users who were dependent on CyanogenMod custom ROMs for all of their Android using life (yes, they exist). But all hope is not lost since all of the source code is present in a repository that can be downloaded by anyone. So, developers can actually keep the project alive at their own will. This article is for those who've been desperate to find a replacement since whenever a new Android version launches, they would want to finally upgrade. Here's a listing of the top alternatives to CyanogenMod that you can explore. We've tried to cover most of them and summarise the top features to help you make a decision on which one to choose. The following custom ROMs have been presented randomly and in no order of preference.

Paranoid Android

Custom ROM enthusiasts will swear by Paranoid Android after CyanogenMod as it consists of a few unique features. The iconic pie navigation bar could be enabled by long pressing the home button which would throw up additional menus to use the navigation bar via gestures. The Hover mode is similar to pop-up notifications seen on WhatsApp but in PA, tapping on any notification will invoke the hover window to interact with the app. Think of it as a floating window

that lets you use the app on a pop-up window without closing the previous app you were using. CyanogenMod's theme engine is included in the ROM, and the corresponding Android version's theme should work in the ROM, but we are still waiting on how the absence of a theme engine in CyanogenMod 14 will work out.

[Link: aospa.co](http://aospa.co)



Slim ROM

As the name suggests, Slim ROMs are small in size while packing useful features. It consists of a dark theme built-in that can be enabled in the settings menu with just one tap. You'll also find Slim's own version of the Pie menu called SlimPIE based on PA's and CyanogenMod's Pie menu. The other unique features in Slim ROM include Slim dialer, Shake events, notification and lock screen shortcuts, and an interesting feature to send you notification reminders. Updates on Slim ROM builds are supposed to be more frequent on newer versions, so if you're really keen on staying ahead when receiving the latest updates, you should consider this